

INNOVATION TIMES

INTERCONNECT 26.0

Interdisciplinary Innovation Challenge

SPONSORED BY **STRENGTH ARENA**, DAVANAGERE

HAVE AN IDEA? BUILD IT.

Turn your innovative thoughts into real-world solutions through collaboration across domains.



WHAT IS INTERCONNECT 26.0?

InterConnect 26.0 is an interdisciplinary innovation initiative where students from different branches come together to solve real-world problems through collaboration and creativity.

Participants can either:

- Submit innovative ideas and actively work on developing them
- Contribute their technical and domain skills to existing ideas through the platform

Students collaborate in interdisciplinary teams to design, build, and develop meaningful and impactful real-world solutions.

Phase 1: Online (Project-Based Work)



1. IDEA

SUBMIT YOUR IDEA OR CHOOSE AN EXISTING PROBLEM STATEMENT



2. COLLABORATE

JOIN A PROJECT TEAM AND CONTRIBUTE BY COMPLETING TASKS



3. BUILD

CONTRIBUTE BY WORKING ON TASKS AND BUILDING THE SOLUTION

Phase 2: Offline (Final Presentation)

April 10 2026 - Registration Closes

Till April 17 - Development Phase

April 18, - Final Presentation/Event



Scan for registration

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01 · Platform Overview

iConnect 26.0 is a collaborative open-source event where real-world problem statements are solved by student contributors working in an organized, GitHub-driven environment. The platform tracks contributions, awards points, and ranks participants on a live leaderboard.

Concept	Detail
Project ID Format	P-000X (assigned by platform)
Points Range	5 pts (min) → 100 pts (max) per task
Deadline Window	1 day → 30 days (set by Coordinator per task)
Task Claim Model	First-Come-First-Served (FIFO) — first to click gets it
Review Authority	Coordinator reviews & closes task to release points

02 · Role: Owner ■

Owners are problem statement publishers — individuals or organizations who have identified a real-world challenge and want the iConnect community to build a solution for it.

■ Owner Responsibilities

Problem Statement Submission

Owners are responsible for uploading a clear and detailed problem statement on the iConnect platform. The submission must describe the real-world problem, the expected solution, the domain/industry it belongs to, and any constraints or preferences (tech stack, platform type, etc.) so that contributors and coordinators can fully understand the scope before work begins.

Technical Participation (Optional)

Owners who possess technical knowledge are welcome to contribute to their own project's development. They will be treated exactly like Contributors for tasks they complete — claiming issues, submitting PRs, and earning points accordingly.

■ *Owner's primary job is to be available for clarification when the Coordinator reaches out with questions.*

03 · Role: Coordinator ■

Coordinators are the backbone of project execution. Each coordinator is assigned one or more projects and is responsible for translating the owner's vision into actionable tasks for contributors.

■ Coordinator Responsibilities

A. Project Onboarding

- Get assigned to a project by the iConnect admin team.
- Reach out to the Owner immediately — understand requirements, expected output, tech stack, and any resources they can provide (designs, APIs, data, etc.).
- Collect all necessary assets: requirement docs, Figma links, reference materials, etc.

B. Mandatory Project Setup ★

- ★ Create a GitHub Repository for the assigned project. The repo link **MUST** be added to the project on iConnect.
- ★ Create a dedicated WhatsApp group for the project community under iConnect 26.0 — format: iConnect 26.0 | . Add all enrolled contributors.
- ★ Add the WhatsApp community link to the project's Community field on the platform.
- ★ If a hosted/live URL exists, add it to the project links section.
- ★ If the Owner provides external resources (docs, drive, links), add them to the project resources section.

C. Task / Issue Management

- Break the project into granular, well-defined tasks.
- For each task — first create a GitHub Issue in the project repo with full description & acceptance criteria.
- Then come to iConnect platform → Create Log → fill Task Title, Description, Requirements, GitHub Issue Link, assign Points (5–100), and set Deadline Window (1–30 days).
- Publish the log only when it is ready for contributors to claim.
 - Note: Log is saved as DRAFT until you explicitly publish it.

D. Communication

- After publishing a task, immediately send a message in the WhatsApp group — announce that a new task is live on the platform and anyone interested should claim it ASAP.
- Be responsive to contributor queries on GitHub and WhatsApp.

E. Task Review & Closure

- When a contributor marks a task complete, review their GitHub commit/PR link and Completion Note.
- Verify the work meets the acceptance criteria defined in the GitHub issue.
- Click 'Close Task' on the platform to approve — this credits points to the contributor.
- If the work is rejected, communicate clearly what needs to be fixed before re-submission.

■ *Coordinators must NOT merge anything to the main branch without review. Contributors push to their own sub-branch — Coordinator reviews before merging.*

04 · Role: Contributor ■

Contributors are the builders of iConnect. They browse problem statements, join projects they are passionate about, claim tasks, build solutions, and earn points that reflect on the leaderboard.

■ Contributor Responsibilities

A. Enrolling in a Project

Step 1. Login to iConnect platform.

Step 2. Navigate to Problem Statement section from the top nav.

Step 3. Browse available problem statements and click on one you like.

Step 4. Click 'View' → scroll down → click 'Join Project Pipeline' button.

Step 5. You are now enrolled! The project appears in your Dashboard → My Projects.

B. Setting Up Your GitHub Workspace

- Open the project from Dashboard → click on the project card.
- Click the GitHub Repo link in the project panel to go to the repository.
- ★ **Create a sub-branch in the repo named after yourself. Format: contributor/ (e.g., contributor/vinayaka-k)**
- ★ **Join the WhatsApp community group linked in the project panel — this is MANDATORY.**
- Never push directly to the main branch. All your work goes to your personal sub-branch.

C. Claiming a Task

- Watch the WhatsApp group — Coordinator will announce when a new task is published.
- Go to Dashboard → scroll to 'Available Tasks' section.
- Find the task and click 'I'm Interested / Initiate Task' button.
- First person to click gets the task — FIFO. No exceptions.
- Once claimed, the deadline timer starts immediately.

D. Completing a Task

- Do the work in your personal sub-branch on GitHub.
- Push all commits to your sub-branch — do NOT push to main.
- Link your commits/PR to the GitHub Issue mentioned in the task.
- Go to Dashboard → Active Tasks → find your task → click 'Mark Complete'.
- In the popup window, provide: GitHub Commit/PR Link + Completion Note (brief summary of what you did).
- Click 'Submit Task' — task goes to the Coordinator for review.

E. Points Credit

- Points are credited ONLY after the Coordinator reviews and clicks 'Close Task'.
- If you miss the deadline, you forfeit the points for that task.
- Completed tasks reflect on your Dashboard score and the global Leaderboard.

■ *You can be enrolled in multiple projects simultaneously, but manage your bandwidth wisely — missing deadlines affects your ranking.*

05 · Points & Leaderboard System ■

Points are the currency of iConnect. Every completed and approved task earns you points that instantly update your position on the Global Leaderboard.

Scenario	Points Outcome
Task completed within deadline & approved	Full points credited as assigned (5–100 pts)
Task not completed within deadline	0 pts — task auto-expires
Owner builds their own task (technical)	Full points — same as contributor
Task submitted but coordinator rejects	0 pts until re-submission is approved
Task claimed but abandoned	0 pts + task returned to pool after deadline

■ *Points are assigned by the Coordinator at time of task creation and cannot be changed after publishing. Higher complexity tasks carry more points.*

06 · Task Lifecycle — Step by Step ■

Every task in iConnect follows the exact same lifecycle from creation to point credit. No shortcuts. No exceptions.

1	Coordinator	Creates GitHub Issue with full description & acceptance criteria.
2	Coordinator	Creates Log on iConnect: fills title, description, requirements, GitHub issue link, points, and deadline.
3	Coordinator	Publishes the Log on platform + announces in WhatsApp group.
4	Contributor	Sees task in Available Tasks → clicks 'I'm Interested / Initiate Task'. Deadline timer starts.
5	Contributor	Does the work on their personal sub-branch (contributor/).
6	Contributor	Marks Complete → provides GitHub Commit/PR link + Completion Note → clicks Submit Task.
7	Coordinator	Reviews submission against acceptance criteria.
8	Coordinator	Clicks 'Close Task' if approved → Points instantly credited to contributor.
9	Platform	Leaderboard updates in real-time. Contributor's rank adjusts.

07 · Mandatory Checklist ★

These are non-negotiable requirements. If any of these are missing, the project/task will be considered incomplete regardless of the actual work done.

For Coordinators:

- ★ **GitHub Repo created and link added to project on iConnect platform**
- ★ **WhatsApp Community Group created (iConnect 26.0 |) and link added to platform**
- ★ **All enrolled contributors added to the WhatsApp group**
- ★ **Every task Log must have: Task Title, Description, Requirements/Acceptance Criteria, GitHub Issue Link, Points, Deadline**
- ★ **GitHub Issue must be created BEFORE publishing the Log on iConnect**
- ★ **Announce every new task in WhatsApp group after publishing**
- ★ **Review contributor submissions promptly — do not leave tasks pending for more than 48 hours**

For Contributors:

- ★ **Join the project via 'Join Project Pipeline' button before attempting any task**
- ★ **Create your personal sub-branch: contributor/ in the GitHub repo**
- ★ **Join the WhatsApp Community group linked in the project panel**
- ★ **Never push directly to the main branch**
- ★ **Submit before the deadline — no extensions are granted**
- ★ **Provide valid GitHub Commit/PR link and a clear Completion Note on submission**

08 · General Rules & Code of Conduct ■

Respect all participants	Harassment, abusive language, or discrimination of any kind will result in immediate disqualification from iConnect 26.0.
No plagiarism	Copying code from other participants or submitting AI-generated code without original contribution is prohibited. Coordinators reserve the right to verify authenticity.
Deadline is final	The timer starts the moment you claim a task. There are no extensions. Plan accordingly.
One claim at a time per task	You cannot claim the same task twice. Once claimed, it is yours to complete or forfeit.
Main branch is sacred	No contributor is allowed to push to the main branch. All work must go through the sub-branch → PR → Coordinator review pipeline.

WhatsApp group is mandatory	Every contributor must join the project's WhatsApp community group. Missing group announcements due to not joining is the contributor's responsibility.
Coordinator's decision is final	For task approval/rejection, the Coordinator's assessment is final. Disputes can be escalated to the iConnect admin team only.
Stay active	Claiming a task and going inactive is unfair to other contributors. If you cannot complete a task, release it so others can claim it.

Good luck, build something amazing, and let iConnect 26.0 be the beginning of something great. ■

— iConnect Team